

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Engineer

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniproper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Engineer with over five years of experience in SIEM engineering, detection content development and security operations across large enterprise environments. I have deep, hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel, including workspace design, data connector configuration, analytics rule authoring and optimisation using Kusto Query Language (KQL), workbook development and automated playbook creation using Logic Apps. I have also worked with Splunk and am familiar with Search Processing Language (SPL)-based detection logic. My background spans building and managing a hybrid SOC from the ground up, leading threat hunting activities, triaging and investigating Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) alerts, and serving as the senior incident response escalation lead. I am eligible for Security Check (SC) clearance and am enthusiastic about contributing my detection engineering and SOC operations expertise within a high-performing security function delivering meaningful national outcomes.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel (Strong):** Workspace design, data connectors, KQL analytics rules, automation playbooks (Logic Apps), workbooks, threat hunting queries
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Writing, testing and optimising detection logic, threat hunting queries and reporting dashboards in Microsoft Sentinel
- **Splunk / SPL:** SIEM query development and log analysis using Search Processing Language (SPL)
- **CrowdStrike Falcon (Expert):** NG-SIEM, EDR, Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover — deployed, managed and built hybrid SOC
- **SIEM Engineering and SOC Operations:** Detection content lifecycle, alert triage, correlation rule tuning, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks
- **Threat Hunting:** Intelligence-led hunting using MITRE ATT&CK framework; KQL-based queries across Sentinel and CrowdStrike
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61; senior escalation lead; playbook authoring and lifecycle management
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD:** Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; SOAR automation; Logic Apps
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, MITRE ATT&CK, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Built and currently operates a **hybrid SOC from the ground up** using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM as the primary platform, establishing end-to-end detection and response capability across the organisation
- Designed and maintains **Microsoft Sentinel** workspace, including data connector configuration, **KQL analytics rules**, workbooks and Logic Apps-based automation playbooks
- Develops, tests and deploys **detection content** across both CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel; continuously tunes detection logic to reduce false positives and improve signal quality
- Leads **threat hunting** activities using intelligence-led KQL queries across Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying threats that evade automated detection

- Serves as the **senior incident response escalation lead**, owning the full investigation lifecycle using NIST 800-61 methodology and MITRE ATT&CK for threat classification
- Manages the vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck; tracks remediation and reports findings to senior leadership
- Develops and maintains SOAR playbooks and PowerShell-based automation to streamline SOC workflows and reduce analyst toil
- Produces SOC performance dashboards and security metrics reports for governance and executive stakeholders

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Operated and maintained CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the full endpoint estate, triaging detections, conducting threat investigations and refining prevention policies
- Built initial **Microsoft Sentinel** data connectors and contributed to KQL-based detection rule development prior to transitioning to senior role
- Deployed and managed **Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)** and **Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)** for an 8,000-user environment, delivering integrated XDR telemetry to the SOC
- Managed **Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD)**, Conditional Access policies, MFA and SSO for all staff, significantly reducing identity-based attack surface
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege controls and monitor privileged sessions
- Triaged SIEM alerts, supported incident response activities and contributed to playbook authoring within a structured SOC framework
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck; worked with infrastructure teams to prioritise and track remediation activities

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Supported security and infrastructure operations in a SaaS/FinTech environment, including log monitoring, vulnerability assessments and patch management
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate security and infrastructure tasks, reducing manual effort and improving repeatability
- Assisted in penetration test finding remediation and supported ISO 27001 compliance programme delivery

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and delivered a **hybrid SOC capability from the ground up**, combining CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel to provide comprehensive threat detection and response coverage
- Authored and deployed **KQL detection rules and Microsoft Sentinel workbooks** that measurably reduced the mean time to detect threats and improved analyst situational awareness
- Developed a **SOAR automation playbook library** that automated routine enrichment and containment tasks, freeing analyst capacity for high-value investigation work
- Led intelligence-led **threat hunting campaigns** using MITRE ATT&CK-mapped KQL queries, surfacing previously undetected attacker techniques and strengthening detection coverage
- Delivered **Microsoft MDE and MDI integration** into the SOC for 8,000 users, providing XDR-level visibility across endpoints and identities

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+

- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)